

are quite important for the Indian consumer. Echoing this view, 91 per cent (Fig. 5) of participants have said that additional scope for business lies in the area of reverse logistics. They feel that services related to repair/reworking and refurbishment work will not only help EMS firms get additional business from OEMs but also enable them to play a role in e-waste management. However, considering the complexity of reverse logistics processes, only a few expert EMS providers in India can enter this space.

The way ahead

We asked the participants to suggest possible challenges that could derail the growth of this industry in India. Here is a collation of their concerns:

- Unorganised nature of the sector puts cost pressures on quality

Major contributors to this report

- Amit Bhargava, managing director, Asha Electronics
- Ankit Jain, director, Ankit Electronics
- Deepak G. Sawant, managing director, Interfab Electronics India Pvt Ltd
- Indrajit Vank, proprietor, Arkay Technologies
- Milan Patel, chief executive officer, Aminij Embedded Solutions
- Muneesh Dhawan, vice president, Dixon technologies (India) Pvt Ltd
- R.K. Kapur, partner, Vital Electronics & Manufacturing Co.
- Ronak Sonthalia, director, Silizon
- Sreeram Srinivasan, chief executive officer, Syrma Technologies
- Subhash Goyal, managing director, Digital Circuits Pvt Ltd
- Vijay Gujarathi, director, EOS Power India

- service providers and creates issues in the entire value chain
- Inefficient supply chain for required electronic components is a major concern
- An unfair playing field, since companies from competing countries (China, Vietnam, Indonesia, etc) have access to finance at much lower costs
- Logistics inefficiencies and infra-

structural bottlenecks, resulting in greater turnaround time and costs

- Higher cost of infrastructure
- Shortage of skilled manpower

Survey participants felt that the successful resolution of the above-mentioned issues through appropriate industry initiatives and government interventions will help this industry move ahead. **EFY**

support@efy.in

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